

Friday, July 29

The day was spent getting ready for Calgary. Matthew had us up as early as usual. I trimmed, watered and weeded the lawn and beds by 9:00. Cheryl has organized the operation with three lists. Peter walks around the house with his swimming goggles on his neck. Peter and I made a couple of trips about town to buy a hacksaw for locks with no keys on the car top carrier, a timer for our living room light, two gifts from Cheryl's parents for Peter and Matthew, traveler's cheques, Peter's swimming card, my rugby pants from the Squire Shop, to put a stop on our mail, pick up a nut, bolt and lock for the carrier. When we finally got home Cheryl was all packed according to her magnificent lists. Peter was talkative. Death has taken up as much of his thinking time as wondering what people are doing on the other side of the world. Peter asked me if we will live forever. I said no. Peter rolled his hands palm upwards and said, "Well I guess that is what life is made of." We were invited to the Hospitality Inn by Cheryl's parents for half-price suppers. We arrived at 5:30 and got our tables. The waiter was young, blown-dry and bare-chested, well suited to giving orders at a singles bar. He took our orders while looking over the room for better options. There was a small foul-up with the food.

Cheryl's mother said, "He's too busy looking for pretty girls."

Peter jumped to his feet and said, "Where? Where are the pretty girls?"

No one showed him so he repeated, "Where are the pretty girls?"

Cheryl's dad talked about the MVA director's committee problems with a Saskatchewan Crescent developer of condominiums.

After the restaurant we visited with Jed and Helen Dyck. Peter played with Merlin, an electronic reflex and memory game. Matthew performed for Jed's niece, a nursing student looking for a summer job. We sat in the room off the kitchen with the southern view and talked about school, cruise missile protests, Jed's carpentry projects, the football game between Saskatchewan and Toronto, the Cosmopolitan magazine for women, and the difference between having and not having children as one makes life decisions. Cheryl and I were interested in a book of theirs that imagined a conversation between Aldous Huxley, C.S. Lewis

and J.F. Kennedy. We had dessert and coffee, talked some more and drove our already packed car home and left.

Saturday July 30

We had an early breakfast at Saskatoon Inn with Cheryl's parents. The restaurant was very busy handling a Charismatic Catholic's conference. Peter and I shared pancakes and sausage. Cheryl had poached eggs and toast. After the breakfast I took the bill from the waitress. As we went to the cash register, Cheryl's dad tried reaching around me for it. Quietly he said, "Come on Dave, this is embarrassing."

We wished each other well and left for Calgary. The day was sunny. Peter soon complained about being too hot. Cheryl, on the other hand, was cold and held a pillow on her lap. They switched places for the rest of the trip. Peter was sucking on a large piece of ice and got it stuck in his mouth. He yelled for help. His eyes were full of tears. I managed to pull it free, like removing a stick from a trap. He cried awhile. We stopped in Drumheller for an hour. We had shakes and ice-cream at the Waldorf Hotel. Matthew ate dry toast. We went to a nearby IGA and bought some baby food and fruit. The store management had a list set under glass at the checkout counter of those who had not reimbursed the store for NSF cheques. Three weddings passed by the store. As we were getting in the car a tall fellow stopped to fawn over the children. He talked with a drunkard's sincerity (though I don't know if he was drunk).

"He (Matthew) reminds me of my own boy. Better looking maybe. Yeah, better looking. Families are good. Keep it. I don't see my boys much anymore. I don't see my wife."

The drive from Drumheller, especially both sides of Beiseker, is surprisingly beautiful. One looks at the farms, the crops, the fallowed fields, the ditches, and imagines a large neighbourhood kept trim, shaded, clean. We made Calgary by 4:25 and reached Michael's condominium with no trouble. Michael was waiting. He was at the balcony and squirted water on us as we passed underneath with our bags. After bringing in the luggage we walked to a nearby Safeway and bought groceries. Michael phoned Cathy from there and made plans to meet her at his place a little later. We walked back. The groceries were awfully heavy for \$51.

We went for supper at Sam's Deli on 4th St. SW. It was in a renovated building, but made to look as it might have been, with mortar squeezed and broken, vertical wall boards stained red-brown with thick varnished, and windows decorated for the effect of shadows falling over everything. It wasn't so much a place for families, but the waitresses enjoyed the boys, stalking to them, making faces. Cheryl and I split a BBQ beef sandwich. Peter had a hamburger. Michael had ham and dill. Cathy had a Caesar's salad. Cheesecake all around. The bill was \$33.

We walked a few blocks to Cathy's apartment. Her balcony looks onto the Elbow River. Peter and I watched a family of ducks swim here and there. The mother was confused. A band was playing at the Exhibition across the river. We looked at Cathy's family album, at individual pictures and her Quebec pictures. When we returned to Michael's the boys were bathed and put to bed. Peter slept on the floor and Matthew went down on the king-size waterbed. It has a mirror in the headboard. The four of us talked in the living room. Michael asked about guitars and guitar music. We discussed Leona Boyd, Nietzsche, Calvinism and the Lutheran Reformation and the sexual freedom/bondage within certain social groups. At midnight we went to bed.